ALLAMAHUL BAYAN SERIES · BOOK 78

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

My First Setswana Alphabet

Ditlhaka tsa me tsa ntlha tsa Setswana

A Coloring Book to Learn, Trace & Say the 27 Setswana Letters with English Phonetics

A a B b D d

Written by Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza

Illustrations: AI-assisted, edited by the author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah

مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

REVIEW DRAFT — not for publication

REVIEW DRAFT — DO NOT PUBLISH YET. The letter names, sound guides, words, transliterations and phrases in this book were drafted with AI and have not yet been checked by a native speaker. After review, set `draft=False` in the language file and rebuild; this notice then disappears.

My First Setswana Alphabet — Ditlhaka tsa me tsa ntlha tsa Setswana
Allamahul Bayan Series, Book 78

Text copyright © 2026 Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza. All rights reserved.
No part of this book may be reproduced, stored or shared in any form without written permission from the publisher, except that parents and teachers may copy pages for use with their own children or class.

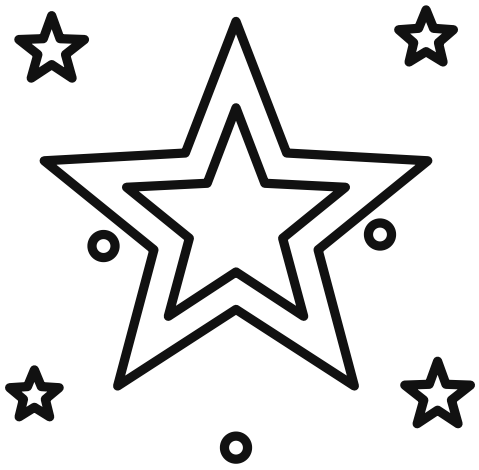
Published by **Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah** (مكتبة كنوز الآخرة),
An imprint of the Kunujul Akhirah Charitable Trust, Bangladesh.
Contact: minhaz.reza87@gmail.com

First edition, 2026.

Illustrations: line art created with AI assistance and reviewed by the author. In keeping with the publisher's guidelines, the pictures show objects, plants and nature only — no people or animals.

Fonts: Baloo 2, Noto Sans, Fredoka, Nunito, Amiri and Dancing Script, all under the SIL Open Font License.
Map data: Natural Earth (public domain).

A note of respect: this book contains verses of the Noble Qur'an (pages 4–5). Please handle it with care and keep it in a clean place.



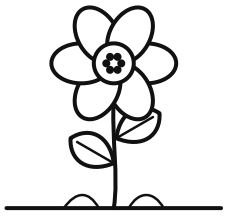
This book belongs to

Buka e ke ya

I started learning Setswana on







ABOUT THIS SERIES

The Allamahul Bayan Series

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

ʿallamahul-bayān — "He taught him clear expression"

الرَّحْمَٰنُ ﴿١﴾ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ ﴿٢﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ ﴿٣﴾ عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ ﴿٤﴾

Ar-Raḥmān. ʿAllamal-Qurʾān. Khalaqal-insān. ʿAllamahul-bayān.

"The Most Merciful. He taught the Qur'an. He created the human being. He taught him clear expression (al-bayān)."

Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4[1]

Surah Ar-Raḥmān — the chapter of *The Most Merciful* — opens by naming some of Allah's greatest gifts to us. First, **He taught the Qur'an**. Then, **He created the human being**. And then, **He taught him al-bayān**.

What does *al-bayān* mean? It comes from an Arabic root that means *to make something clear*. Al-bayān is the gift of speech and understanding: being able to put what is in our hearts and minds into words, to explain, to listen, and to be understood. Animals make sounds, but only people were taught to speak, read and write in languages. Scholars of tafsīr explain that this gift is what lets us learn, teach and pass on guidance — including the Qur'an itself.

So every time a child says a new word, sounds out a letter, or writes their first line in a new language, they are using a gift that Allah Himself says He taught. That is the heart of this series: **learning languages as a way of thanking Allah for al-bayān.**

Languages and colours: two signs of Allah

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافُ أَلْسِنَتِكُمْ وَأَلْوَانِكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّلْعَالِمِينَ ﴿٢٢﴾

Wa min āyātihī khalqus-samāwāti wal-arḍi wakh-tilāfu alsinatikum wa alwānikum. Inna fī dhālika la-āyātil-lil-ʿālimīn.

"And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the earth, and the variety of your languages and your colours. Surely in that are signs for those who know."

Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22[1]

In Surah Ar-Rūm, Allah tells us that the **many languages** of people and their **many colours** are among His signs. A coloring book that teaches a language brings both of these signs together in a child's hands: they meet a new language, and they fill its letters with colour.

وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا

Wa jaʿalnākum shuʿūban wa qabāʾila li-taʿārafū.

"...and We made you into peoples and tribes so that you may get to know one another."

Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13 (part)[1]

Allah made us into many peoples *so that we may get to know one another*. Learning even a few letters of someone's language is a beautiful first step towards knowing them.

How each book in the series works

Every book introduces one language **through English**:

- where the language is spoken, with a map to color;
- every letter of its alphabet, with its name in the language itself *and* in English letters;
- simple English sound guides, so a parent who has never heard the language can still help;
- a word and picture for every letter, to color, trace and say out loud.

Book 78 is Setswana. More languages from around the world are in the series, in shā' Allāh.

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

How to use this book

Begin with **Bismillah**, and go **little and often**: one letter a day is plenty for a young child. For each letter:

1. **Say it.** Read the letter's name and its sound guide together. Say it three times.
2. **Color it.** Color the big letter any way your child likes.
3. **Trace it.** Trace the dotted letters with a pencil, then try one alone in the empty boxes.
4. **Meet the word.** Say the word, color the picture, and talk about it in English.

Marker tip: every coloring page has a blank back, so colours cannot spoil the next activity. Slip a sheet of scrap paper behind the page you are coloring anyway — it keeps the next page clean.

Reading the English sound guides

- **CAPITALS** show the stressed syllable: *leh-TSAH-tsee* means "say TSAH a little louder". Setswana stress is usually on the next-to-last syllable.
- **kh** in the English guide is the rasping throat sound of Setswana **g**, like Arabic غ.
- **t'h** and **ts'h** mean a strong puff of air after the t — not the 'th' of "think".
- **N-** or **M-** at the start of a word is a short hum: *N-tloh*.

Three ways to see every sound

Each letter page shows the sound three ways: the letter's **Setswana name** written in Setswana (native phonetics), the **same name in English letters**, and an **English sound guide**. The box marked *Setswana sound · syllables* shows the letter as Setswana children say it (B is «ba») and its row of syllables — the way Setswana is taught in school.

The pronunciation guides are simplified for young learners and follow Standard Setswana as written in Botswana and South Africa.

MEET THE LANGUAGE

Hello, Setswana! Setswana

seh-TSWAH-nah — the Setswana word for the language

Who speaks it?
More than **10 million people** speak Setswana, as their first language or as a second one.[3]

Where?
In **Botswana**, where almost everyone speaks it, and in **South Africa**, mostly in the North West. Smaller groups live in **Namibia** and **Zimbabwe**.

How is it written?
In the **Latin alphabet**, from **left to right**, with letter groups such as *tl*, *tlh* and *kg* for its special sounds.

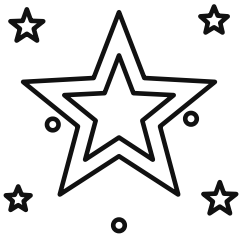
How many letters?
21 letters, plus **letter groups** such as *th*, *ts* and *tsh*.

One word, many shapes
A **Motswana** is one person, the **Batswana** are the people, **Setswana** is the language and **Botswana** is the land!

Did you know?
Botswana's money is called *pula*, which means **rain**. In a dry land, rain is a precious blessing. People even say "*Pula!*" to cheer!







The Setswana Alphabet ditlhaka

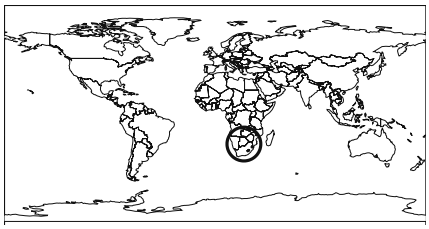
21 letters – ditlhaka tsa Setswana

Aa *ah*	**Bb** *bah*	**Dd** *dah*	**Ee** *eh*	**Ff** *fah*	**Gg** *khah*	**Hh** *hah*
Ii *ee*	**Jj** *jah*	**Kk** *kah*	**Ll** *lah*	**Mm** *mah*	**Nn** *nah*	**Oo** *oh*
Pp *pah*	**Rr** *rah*	**Ss** *sah*	**Tt** *tah*	**Uu** *oo*	**Ww** *wah*	**Yy** *yah*

6 letter groups – ditlhaka tse di kopaneng

Kg kg *kkhah*	**Th th** *t'hah*	**Tl tl** *tlah*	**Tlh tlh** *tlhah*	**Ts ts** *tsah*	**Tsh tsh** *ts'hah*

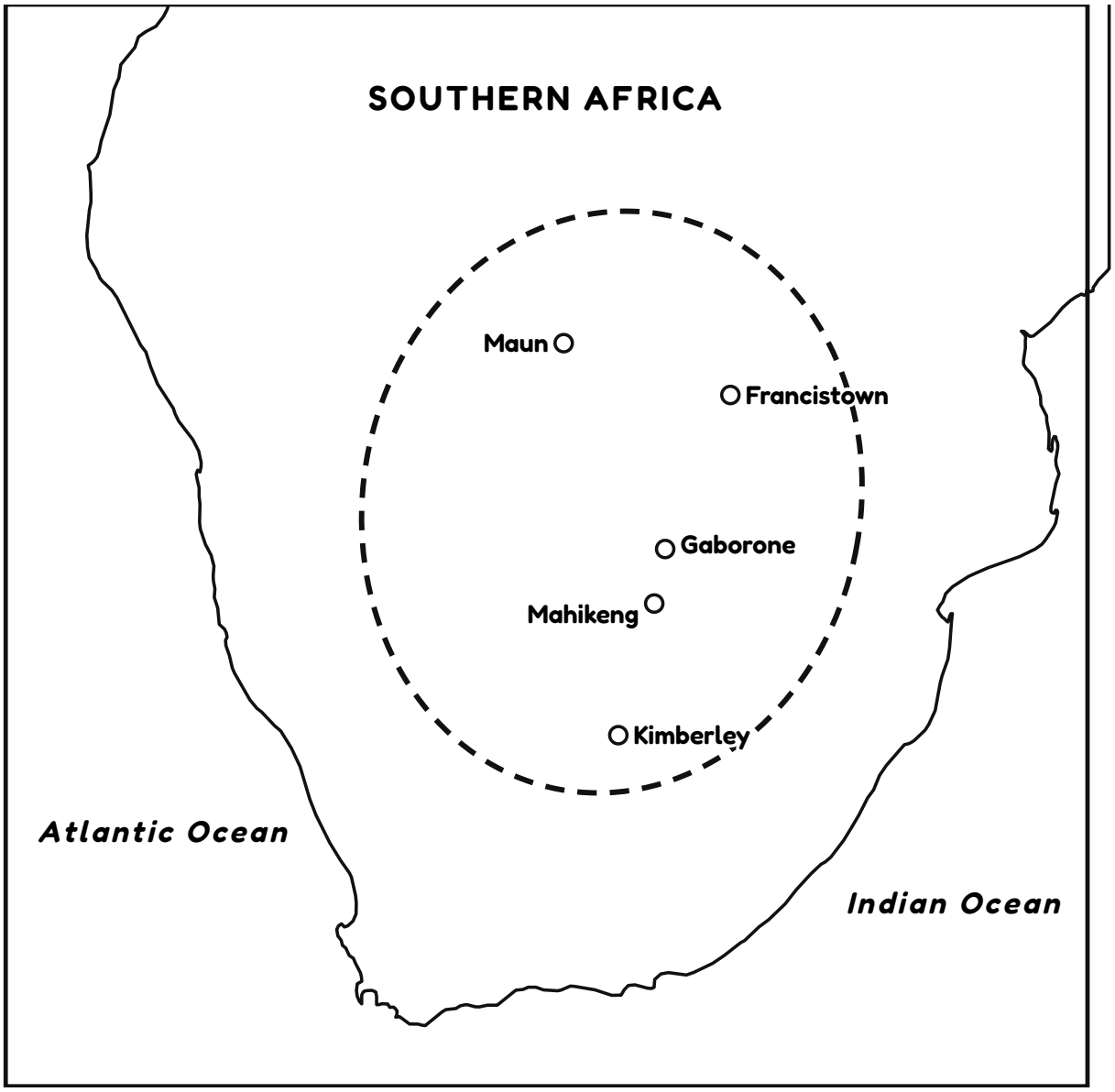
Read the alphabet row by row — the same order as in this book.



The circle shows southern Africa on the world map.

COLOR THE MAP

Where is Setswana spoken?



Color it: the land **green** · the oceans **blue**. **Find it:** Setswana is spoken in Gaborone, Francistown, Maun, Mahikeng and Kimberley. The dashed line shows where most Setswana speakers live.

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

THE LETTERS

The Letters ditlhaka tsa Setswana

dee-TLHAH-kah tsah seh-TSWAH-nah — "the Setswana letters"

Setswana is written with **21 letters**. Words of its own use no C, Q, V, X or Z.

Easy to read aloud
Setswana is written just as it sounds, and almost every word ends with a vowel. Children learn to read by singing the syllables: *ba be bi bo bu, da de di do du…*

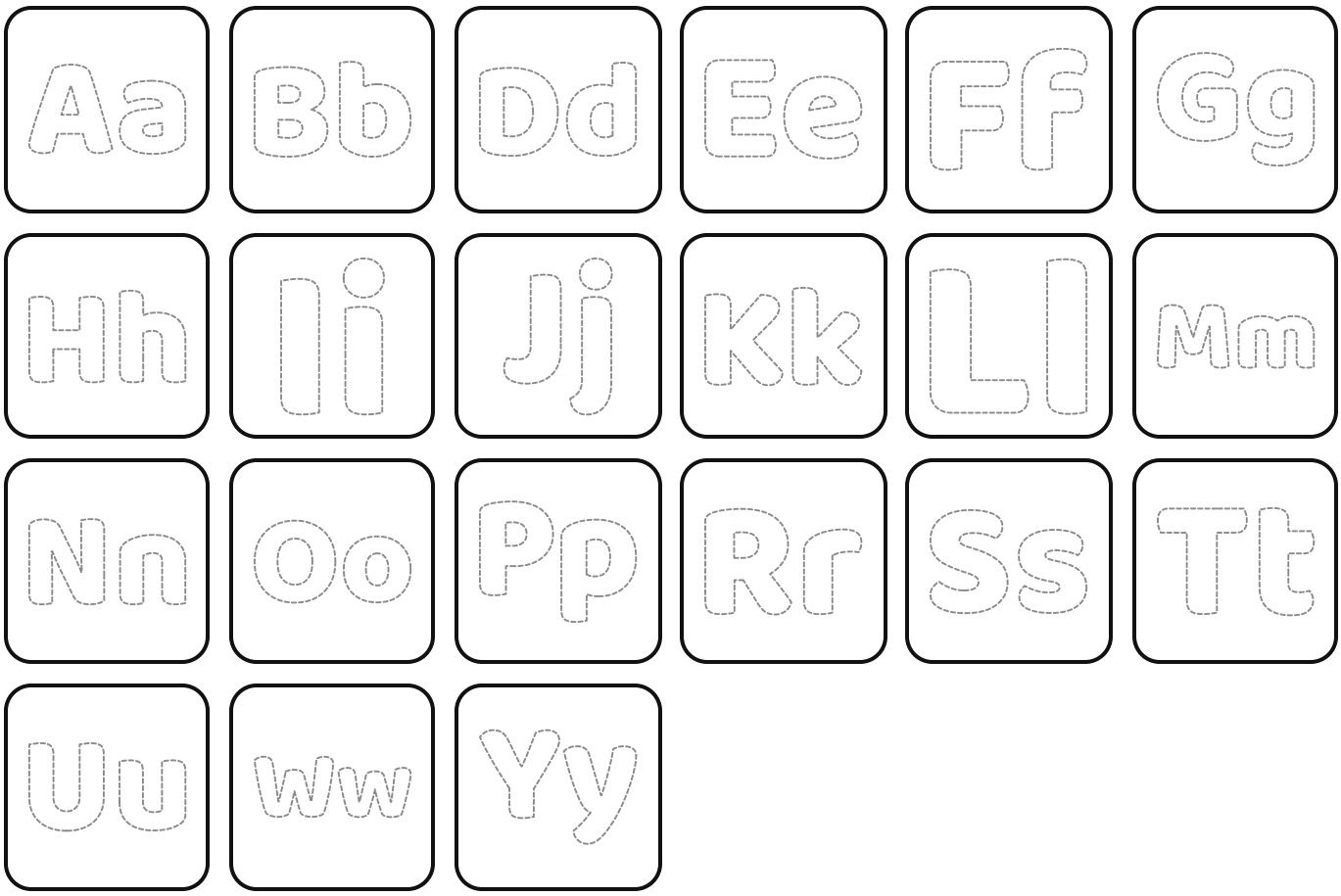
Five vowels
A E I O U say *ah, eh, ee, oh, oo*. E and O each have an open and a closed sound, like "bed"/"day" and "more"/"go".

Big and small
Each page shows the **capital letter** and the **small letter** side by side: **Aa**. Color both!

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the letters ditlhaka tsa Setswana

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



Aa

NAME · LEINA

a

ah

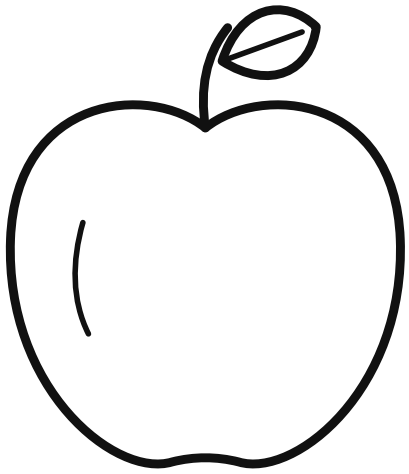
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘a’ as in “father”

SETSWANA SOUND · SYLLABLES

A a — «a»

ba · da · ka · ma · na



AA **IS FOR**

apole

ah-POH-leh

apple

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · KWALA

Aa Aa Aa Aa

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Bb

NAME · LEINA

ba

bah

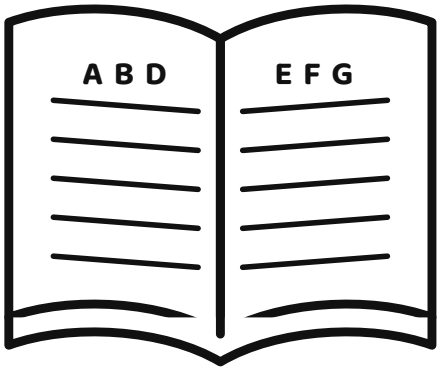
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘b’ as in “ball” (soft, lips barely touching)

SETSWANA SOUND · SYLLABLES

B b — «ba»

ba · be · bi · bo · bu



BB IS FOR

buka

BOO-kah

book

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · KWALA

Bb Bb Bb Bb

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Dd

NAME · LEINA

da

dah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

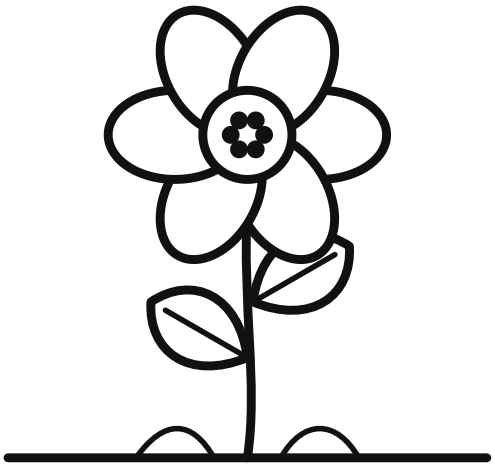
‘d’ as in “door” — in Setswana it comes before **i** and **u**

SETSWANA SOUND · SYLLABLES

D d — «da»

da · de · di · do · du

la · le · lo but di · du: L turns into D before i and u!



DD IS FOR

dithunya

dee-TOO-nyah

flowers

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · KWALA

Dd Dd Dd Dd

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Ee

NAME · LEINA

e

eh

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

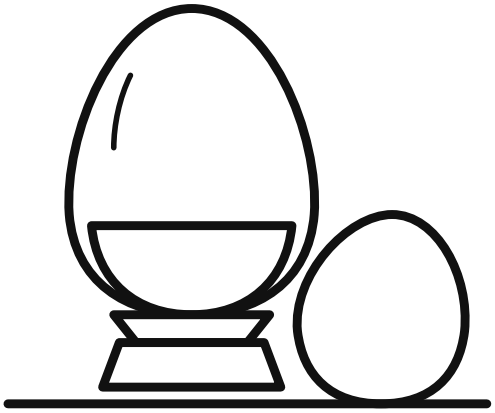
‘e’ as in “bed”, or ‘ay’ as in “day”

SETSWANA SOUND · SYLLABLES

E e — «e»

be · de · ke · me · ne

Few Setswana naming words start with E. Find it twice in *lee* — say each e!



EE IS FOR

lee

LEH-eh

egg

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · KWALA

Ee Ee Ee Ee

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Ff

NAME · LEINA

fa

fah

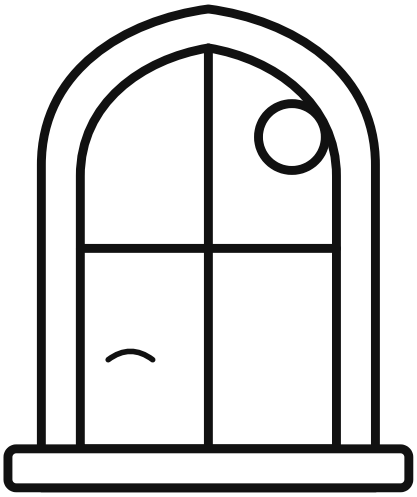
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘f’ as in “fan”

SETSWANA SOUND · SYLLABLES

F f — «fa»

fa · fe · fi · fo · fu



FF IS FOR

fensetere

fen-seh-TEH-reh

window

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · KWALA

Ff Ff Ff Ff

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Gg

NAME · LEINA

ga

khah

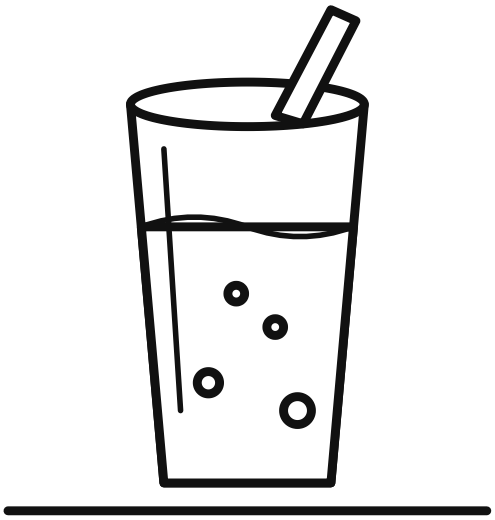
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a rasping sound in the throat, like Arabic خ (kh) — never ‘g’ as in “go”

SETSWANA SOUND · SYLLABLES

G g — «ga»

ga · ge · gi · go · gu



GG IS FOR

galase

khah-LAH-seh

drinking glass

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · KWALA

Gg Gg Gg Gg

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Hh

NAME · LEINA

ha

hah

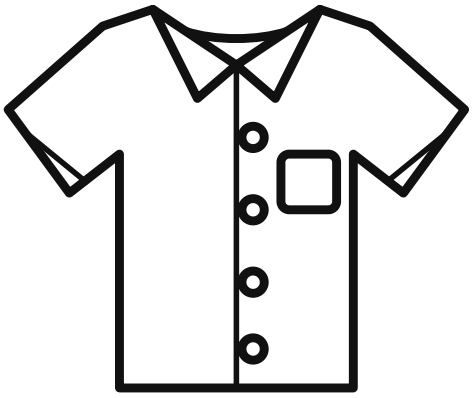
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘h’ as in “hat” (mostly in words from other languages)

SETSWANA SOUND · SYLLABLES

H h — «ha»

ha · he · hi · ho · hu



HH IS FOR

hempe

HEM-peh

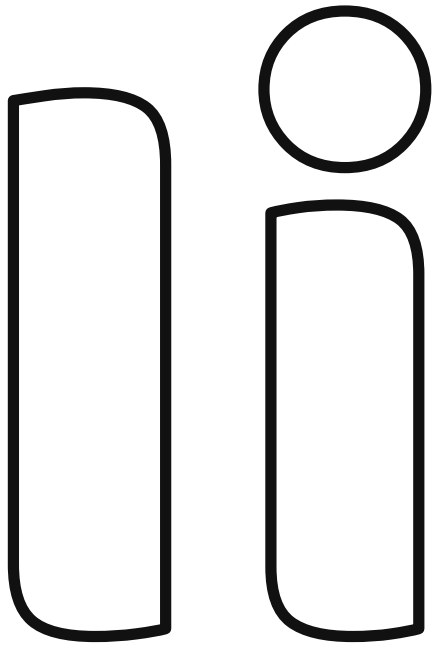
shirt

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · KWALA

Hh Hh Hh Hh

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿



NAME · LEINA

i

ee

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

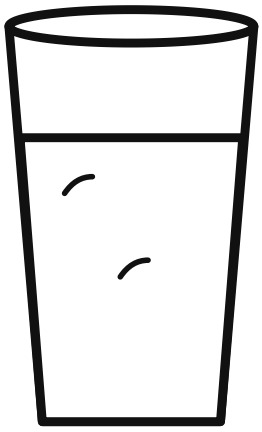
‘ee’ as in “see”

SETSWANA SOUND · SYLLABLES

l i — «i»

bi · di · ki · mi · ni

Few Setswana words start with I. Find it at the end of *metsi*!



II IS FOR

metsi

MEH-tsee

water

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · KWALA

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Jj

NAME · LEINA

ja

jah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘j’ as in “jam”

SETSWANA SOUND · SYLLABLES

J j — «ja»

ja · je · ji · jo · ju

Find J in the middle of *bojang*.



JJ IS FOR

bojang

boh-JAHNG

grass

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · KWALA

Jj Jj Jj Jj

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Kk

NAME · LEINA

ka

kah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘k’ as in “skip” (no puff of air)

SETSWANA SOUND · SYLLABLES

K k — «ka»

ka · ke · ki · ko · ku



KK IS FOR

kopi

KOH-pee

cup

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · KWALA

Kk Kk Kk Kk

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Ll

NAME · LEINA

la

lah

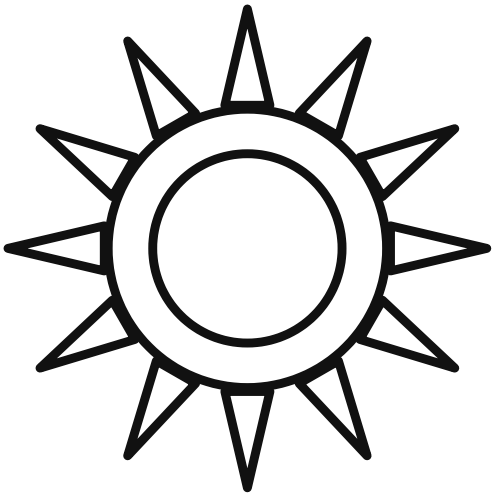
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'l' as in "lamp"

SETSWANA SOUND · SYLLABLES

L l — «la»

la · le · li · lo · lu



LL IS FOR

letsatsi

leh-TSAH-tsee

sun

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · KWALA

Ll Ll Ll Ll Ll

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Mm

NAME · LEINA

ma

mah

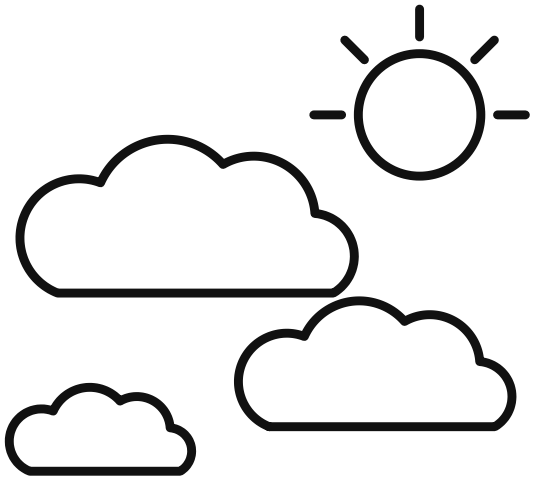
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘m’ as in “moon”

SETSWANA SOUND · SYLLABLES

M m — «ma»

ma · me · mi · mo · mu



MM IS FOR

maru

MAH-roo

clouds

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · KWALA

Mm Mm Mm Mm

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Nn

NAME · LEINA

na

nah

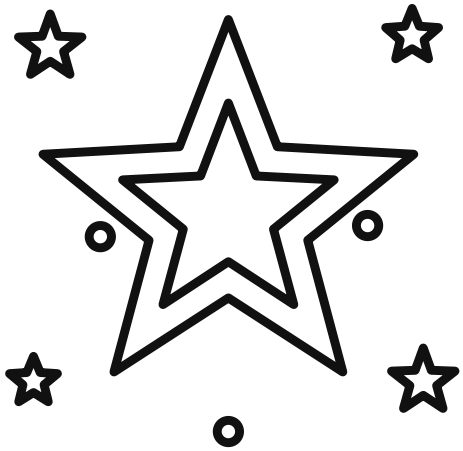
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘n’ as in “net”

SETSWANA SOUND · SYLLABLES

N n — «na»

na · ne · ni · no · nu



NN IS FOR

naledi

nah-LEH-dee

star

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · KWALA

Nn Nn Nn Nn

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Oo

NAME · LEINA

O

oh

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘o’ as in “more”, or ‘oh’ as in “go”

SETSWANA SOUND · SYLLABLES

O o — «o»

bo · do · ko · mo · no

Few Setswana naming words start with O. Find it twice in *molelo*!



OO IS FOR

molelo

moh-LEH-loh

fire

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · KWALA

Oo Oo Oo Oo

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Pp

NAME · LEINA

pa

pah

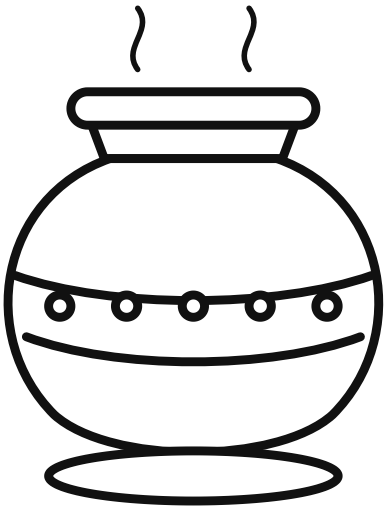
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘p’ as in “spin” (no puff of air)

SETSWANA SOUND · SYLLABLES

P p — «pa»

pa · pe · pi · po · pu



PP IS FOR

pitsa

PEE-tsah

cooking pot

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · KWALA

Pp Pp Pp Pp

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Rr

NAME · LEINA

ra

rah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a rolled ‘r’ — let your tongue buzz!

SETSWANA SOUND · SYLLABLES

R r — «ra»

ra · re · ri · ro · ru



RR **IS FOR**

raese

rah-EH-seh

rice

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · KWALA

Rr Rr Rr Rr

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Ss

NAME · LEINA

sa

sah

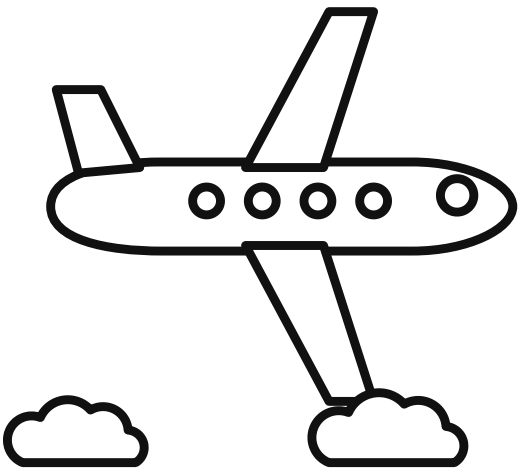
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘s’ as in “sun”

SETSWANA SOUND · SYLLABLES

S s — «sa»

sa · se · si · so · su



SS IS FOR

sefofane

seh-foh-FAH-neh

aeroplane

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · KWALA

Ss Ss Ss Ss

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Tt

NAME · LEINA

ta

tah

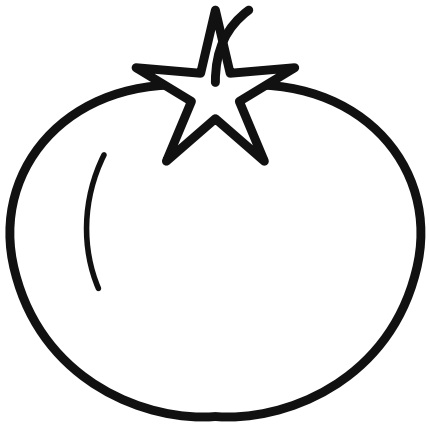
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘t’ as in “stop” (no puff of air)

SETSWANA SOUND · SYLLABLES

T t — «ta»

ta · te · ti · to · tu



TT IS FOR

tamati

tah-MAH-tee

tomato

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · KWALA

Tt Tt Tt Tt

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Uu

NAME · LEINA

u

oo

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘oo’ as in “moon”

SETSWANA SOUND · SYLLABLES

U u — «u»

bu · du · ku · mu · nu

Find U in *pula* — the most loved word in a dry land!



UU IS FOR

pula

POO-lah

rain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · KWALA

Uu Uu Uu Uu

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Ww

NAME · LEINA

wa

wah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

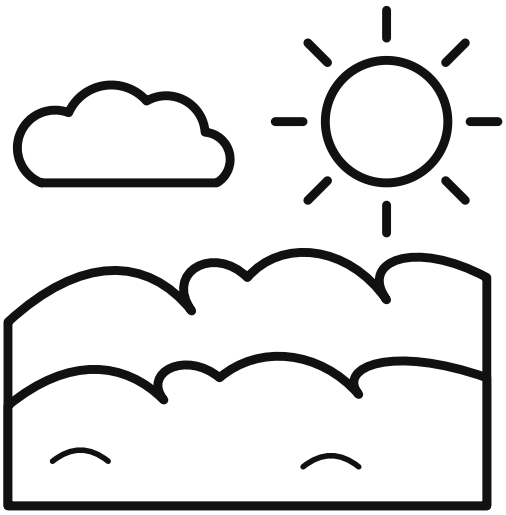
‘w’ as in “water”

SETSWANA SOUND · SYLLABLES

W w — «wa»

wa · we · wi · wo · wu

Find W in the middle of *lewatle*.



WW **IS FOR**

lewatle

leh-WAH-tleh

sea

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · KWALA

Ww Ww Ww Ww

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Yy

NAME · LEINA

ya

yah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

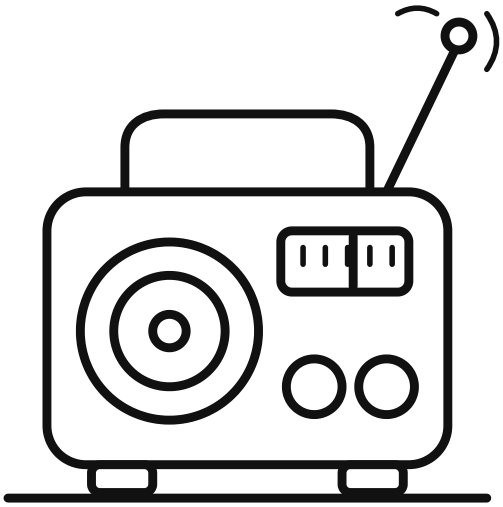
‘y’ as in “yes”

SETSWANA SOUND · SYLLABLES

Y y — «ya»

ya · ye · yi · yo · yu

Find Y twice in *seyalemoya*!



YY IS FOR

seyalemoya

seh-yah-leh-MOH-yah

radio (“it goes on the wind”)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · KWALA

Yy Yy Yy Yy

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

LETTER GROUPS

Letter Groups ditlhaka tse di kopaneng

dee-TLHAH-kah tseh dee koh-pah-NENG — “letters that join together”

Some Setswana sounds are written with **two or three letters together**. Each group makes **one** sound.

Puff of air
An **h** after a letter means “add a puff of air”: **t** is soft, **th** puffs. Hold your hand in front of your mouth and feel the difference!

Special Setswana sounds
tl and **tlh** are said with the sides of the tongue, and **kg** rasps in the throat. Practise them slowly: *ntlo, setlhare, kgwedi*.

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the letter groups ditlhaka tse di kopaneng

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.

Kg kg	Th th	Tl tl
Tlh tlh	Ts ts	Tsh tsh

Kg kg

NAME · LEINA

kga

kkhah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a ‘k’ and the throaty G-sound (kh) said together

SETSWANA SOUND · SYLLABLES

Kg kg — «kga»

kga · kge · kgi · kgo · kgu



KG KG IS FOR

kgwedi

KKHWEH-dee

moon, month

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · KWALA

Kg kg Kg kg Kg kg Kg kg

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Th th

NAME · LEINA

tha

t'hah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

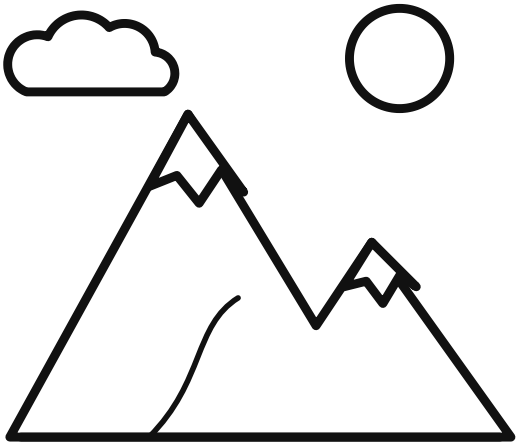
a 't' with a strong puff of air — **not** the 'th' of "think"!

SETSWANA SOUND · SYLLABLES

Th th — «tha»

tha · the · thi · tho · thu

t = no puff · th = big puff of air



TH TH IS FOR

thaba

T'HAH-bah

mountain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · KWALA

Th th Th th Th th Th th

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Tl tl

NAME · LEINA

tla

tlah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

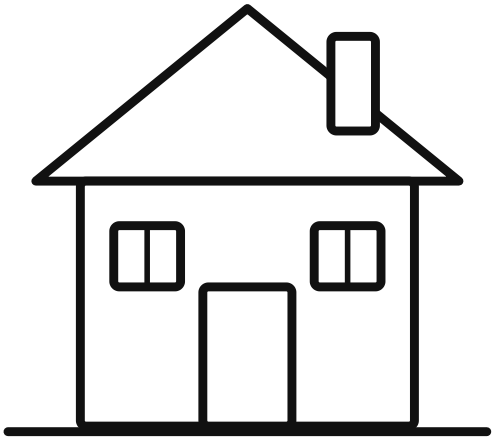
‘t’ and ‘l’ said together, like the end of “bottle”

SETSWANA SOUND · SYLLABLES

Tl tl — «tla»

tla · tle · tli · tlo · tlu

Find TL inside *ntlo*: the N at the front is a short hum.



TL TL IS FOR

ntlo

N-tloh

house

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · KWALA

Tl tl Tl tl Tl tl Tl tl

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Tlh tlh

NAME · LEINA

tlha

tlhah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

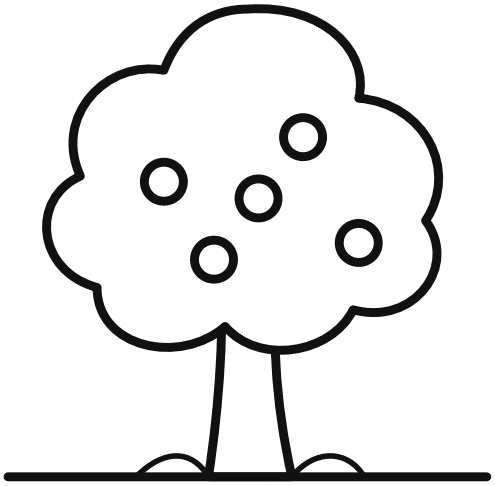
like TL, but with a puff of air out past the sides of the tongue

SETSWANA SOUND · SYLLABLES

Tlh tlh — «tlha»

tlha · tlhe · tlhi · tlho · tlhu

Three letters, one sound! Find TLH inside *setlhare*.



TLH TLH IS FOR

setlhare

seh-TLHAH-reh

tree

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · KWALA

Tlh tlh Tlh tlh Tlh tlh Tlh tlh

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Ts ts

NAME · LEINA

tsa

tsah

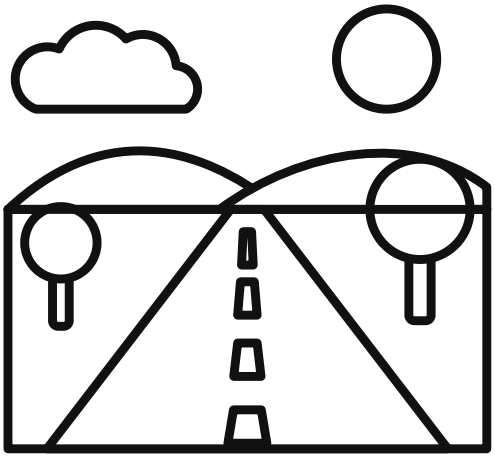
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ts’ as in “cats”

SETSWANA SOUND · SYLLABLES

Ts ts — «tsa»

tsa · tse · tsi · tso · tsu



TS TS IS FOR

tsela

TSEH-lah

road, path

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · KWALA

Ts ts Ts ts Ts ts Ts ts

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Tsh tsh

NAME · LEINA

tsha

ts'hah

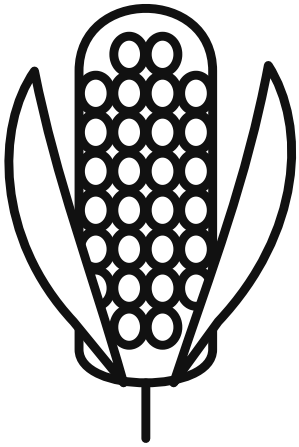
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'ts' with a strong puff of air

SETSWANA SOUND · SYLLABLES

Tsh tsh — «tsha»

tsha · tshe · tshi · tsho · tshu



TSH TSH IS FOR

tshimo

TS'HEE-moh

field, farm

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · KWALA

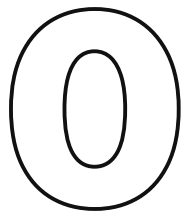
Tsh tsh Tsh tsh Tsh tsh Tsh tsh

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

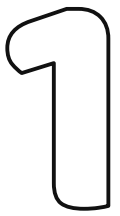
BONUS

Setswana numbers dipalo *(dee-PAH-loh)*

Color the numbers and count out loud in Setswana: *leh-FEH-lah*, *N-ngweh*, *PEH-dee*, *T'HAH-roh*...



0
lefela
leh-FEH-lah
zero



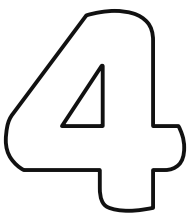
1
nngwe
N-ngweh
one



2
pedi
PEH-dee
two



3
tharo
T'HAH-roh
three



4
nne
N-neh
four



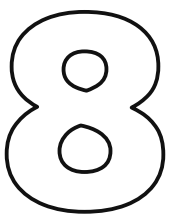
5
tlhano
TLHAH-noh
five



6
thataro
t'hah-T'HAH-roh
six



7
supa
SOO-pah
seven



8
robedi
roh-BEH-dee
eight



9
robongwe
roh-BOH-ngweh
nine

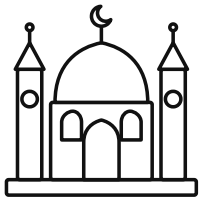
This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

LET'S TALK

My first Setswana words Mafoko a ntlha

Now that you know the letters, try saying these with your family.

Assalamu alaikum	*as-sah-LAH-moo ah-LAY-koom* **Peace be upon you (the Muslim greeting)**
Wa alaikum assalam	*wah ah-LAY-koom as-sah-LAHM* **And peace be upon you (the reply)**
Dumela!	*doo-MEH-lah* **Hello! (to one person)**
Leina la me ke ...	*LAY-nah lah meh keh ...* **My name is ...**
Ke a leboga	*keh ah leh-BOH-khah* **Thank you**
Jazakallahu khairan	*jah-zah-KAL-lah-hoo KHAI-ran* **May Allah reward you with good**
mme · rre	*M-meh · R-reh* **Mother · Father**
morwarre · kgaitsadi	*moh-RWAH-rreh · kkhah-ee-TSAH-dee* **Brother · Sister**
ee · nnyaa	*eh-eh · N-nyah* **Yes · No**
Ke ithuta Setswana!	*keh ee-T'HOO-tah seh-TSWAH-nah* **I am learning Setswana!**







REFERENCES & SOURCES

Where our facts come from

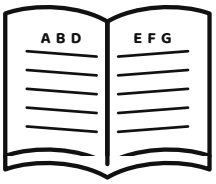
[1] **The Noble Qur'an** — Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4, Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22 and Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13. Arabic text and meanings checked against **Quran.com**; the English meanings in this book are simplified for children.

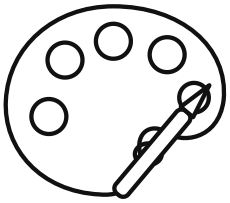
[2] **Map** — outlines from **Natural Earth** (public domain), via the *world-atlas* data set.

[3] **Language facts** — speaker numbers from **Ethnologue** (SIL International), rounded.

What's next?
You have met all **27 Setswana letters**! Keep practising by reading signs, books and food packets written in Setswana, and look out for the other books in the **Allamahul Bayan Series**, in shā' Allāh.

Enjoyed this book?
A short review on Amazon helps other families find it — *jazākumullāhu khayran!*







Certificate of Achievement

Mashallah! O dirile sentle!

MAH-shah-lah! oh dee-REE-leh SEN-tleh! — Mashallah! You did well!

This certifies that

_____

has learned, traced and colored
all 27 letters of the Setswana alphabet.

Date _____ Grown-up's signature _____

Minhaz Reza

Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza, author



Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah — Publisher
An imprint of the Kunujul Akhirah Charitable Trust
مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

✂ Cut out and frame it — the back of this page is blank.